

The prompts and rules I use to run my businesses.

Two halves. First the **5 rules** that make any prompt work properly, then **18 prompts** you can paste today. Swap anything in **[brackets]** for your own details.

Start here. Open Claude or ChatGPT in your browser, or get the app on your phone so you can do this between jobs.

Your first 5 minutes: paste the Brand Brain on page 2, then run the first prompt under Marketing. That is the whole loop, once you have done it once you have got it.

PART 1 • THE 5 RULES THAT FIX ANY PROMPT

Most people type a command and get something generic back. These five lines are what separate a useless answer from one you can actually use. They work on top of every prompt in this pack.

1. Make it ask you first

The single biggest fix. AI guesses when it lacks context, and guesses are generic. Make it interview you instead.

"Before you answer, ask me everything you need to give me the best possible result. Then wait."

2. Give it a role and real limits

"Write me a plan" gets a textbook. A role plus your actual constraints gets a plan you can run on Monday.

*"Act as my **[marketing strategist]**. Budget **[R2,000]**, **[7]** days, goal is **[10 new customers]**. Give me the plan."*

3. Make it grade its own work

The first draft is rarely the best one it can do. Asking for a score forces a rewrite, and the second version is almost always better.

"Now score that out of 10 like a tough editor, and rewrite anything under 8."

4. Show it what good looks like

Describing the tone you want is slow. Showing two examples is instant, and it copies the pattern properly.

*"Here are 2 examples of what good looks like: **[paste]**. Match this exactly."*

5. Make it read back as your customer

You are too close to your own offer. This catches the buried price, the vague ask and the line that loses people.

"Now read that back as my customer. Would you act on it? If not, fix the exact line that lost me."

THE BRAND BRAIN • WRITE THIS ONCE, USE IT FOREVER

The reason AI sounds generic is that it does not know your business. Fill this in once, keep it in your notes, and paste it at the top of any chat before you ask for anything. Everything after it comes back sounding like you.

Paste this before any prompt

Fill in the brackets once. Save it. Reuse it forever.

Here is my business, use this for everything that follows.

Business: [what you do, in one line]

Customer: [who buys, and what they are worried about]

What makes us different: [the honest reason people choose you]

Offers and prices: [list them]

Tone: [how you talk, e.g. warm and direct, no jargon]

Never say: [words or claims you will not use]

Ask me if anything is unclear before you answer.

WHAT THE RULES ACTUALLY CHANGE

TYPICAL PROMPT

"Write a post about my coffee shop."

Comes back with generic filler about "great coffee and cosy vibes" that could belong to any shop in the world. You rewrite it yourself, so you saved nothing.

SAME JOB, RULES APPLIED

"[Brand Brain]. Write a post to fill Tuesday mornings. But first, ask me 5 questions. Then score it out of 10 and rewrite anything under 8."

Comes back asking who your Tuesday customer is and what your slow hours cost you, then writes a post you can publish, and improves it before you have to.

PART 2 • MARKETING & CONTENT

- › Write 2 weeks of Instagram captions for my [business]. Each one needs a hook, one value point, and a clear call to action.
- › Turn this into 5 social posts, one email, and 3 short-video hooks: [paste your blog post or idea].
- › Write 5 scroll-stopping ad headlines for [product or offer] aimed at [customer]. Make them specific, not clever.
- › Give me a month of content ideas for my [business], mixing education, proof, and offers. One line each.

CUSTOMERS & RETENTION

- › Draft a win-back email to customers who have not bought in 90 days. Warm, not salesy, with one clear reason to come back.

- › Write a friendly text reminding **[customer type]** about **[appointment or reorder]**. Keep it under 160 characters.
- › Give me a 3-message follow-up sequence to turn a first-time buyer into a repeat customer for my **[business]**.

ADMIN & OPERATIONS

- › Turn this brain-dump of tasks into a prioritised plan for the week, grouped by impact and effort: **[paste tasks]**.
- › Summarise this email thread into decisions made, who owes what, and my single next action: **[paste]**.
- › Write a simple step-by-step SOP for **[recurring task]** so I can hand it to someone else and it still gets done right.
- › Read this supplier quote and list the questions I should ask before I sign: **[paste]**.

REVIEWS & REPUTATION

- › Reply to this 1-star Google review. Stay calm, take responsibility, and invite them back: **[paste review]**.
- › Write a short message asking my last 10 happy customers for a Google review, with a direct link and no guilt trip.
- › Rewrite this reply so it thanks a happy reviewer and gently opens the door to a referral: **[paste]**.

SALES & MONEY

- › Give me 5 upsell ideas for my **[business]** and the exact words to offer each one at the counter.
- › Rewrite my pricing so the middle option is the obvious choice. Here are my 3 packages: **[paste]**.
- › Write a short, confident follow-up for a lead who went quiet after I sent a price. No desperation.
- › Look at last month's sales and tell me the 3 numbers I should watch every week and why: **[paste]**.

THE TOOL STACK

You do not need 40 AI tools. You need these 5, wired to do real work.

Claude — thinking, writing and building. The one I run my businesses from. claude.ai

Perplexity — research with sources you can actually trust. perplexity.ai

ElevenLabs — studio-grade AI voiceover, in your own voice. elevenlabs.io

Gamma — decks, one-pagers and simple sites in minutes. gamma.app

n8n — wire your tools together so the busywork runs itself. n8n.io

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Do this before you close the file

- Fill in your Brand Brain. Ten minutes, and every prompt after it gets better.
- Run one prompt today. Pick the one that matches the job you are avoiding right now.
- Add rule 1 to a prompt you already use. Watch what changes.

When you want this running by itself rather than prompt by prompt, that is what I build for businesses. New prompts land in your inbox every month.

Built by **Jacques Groenewald**. I run real businesses on this stack and share what actually works, with the real numbers.
jcemedia.com/toolkit